

Outlook

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Can we distinguish a cyber event from a payments outage? - 2024 control review

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Timeouts, host-response failures and repeated attempts can resemble malicious activity or ordinary service degradation. Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

Could the answer be that technical failure explains the cluster? Or are we actually seeing that a concentrated account or terminal pattern suggests abuse? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that operational retries are obscuring the original event.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use March 2024 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is the minimum evidence needed to route an alert to Cyber, Fraud, Payments or Infrastructure. Please send a working Excel file with the exception population and clear columns; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency. This is triage design from available telemetry, not a substitute for SOC, firewall or application logs.

Regards